



FREE GUIDE

Beginner's Strength Routine — 4 Week Plan

A progressive strength plan for women new to lifting or returning after a long break. Three sessions per week, 30–40 minutes each. Compound movements only — the lifts that actually move the needle.

Equipment: A pair of adjustable dumbbells (or a couple of fixed pairs), a sturdy bench or chair, and floor space. That's it.

The 5 Movements You'll Master

1. **Goblet Squat** — hold one dumbbell at chest, squat to parallel.
2. **Romanian Deadlift (RDL)** — hinge at hips, dumbbells slide down thighs.
3. **Dumbbell Row** — one hand on bench, row dumbbell to ribs.
4. **Overhead Press** — dumbbells from shoulders to overhead.
5. **Glute Bridge** — on floor, drive heels down, squeeze glutes hard.

Week 1 & 2 — Foundation

Sessions: Mon / Wed / Fri (or any 3 non-consecutive days).

Sets x Reps: 3 x 8–10 per movement. Rest 60–90 seconds between sets.

Day A	Day B
Goblet Squat · 3x10	RDL · 3x10
Dumbbell Row · 3x10/side	Overhead Press · 3x10
Glute Bridge · 3x12	Goblet Squat · 3x10
Plank · 3x30 sec	Dumbbell Row · 3x10/side

Alternate: Week 1 = A/B/A. Week 2 = B/A/B.

Week 3 & 4 — Build

Sets x Reps: 4 x 8 per movement. Add 5 lbs when you complete all reps with good form.

Day A	Day B
Goblet Squat · 4x8	RDL · 4x8
Dumbbell Row · 4x8/side	Overhead Press · 4x8
RDL · 3x8	Goblet Squat · 3x8
Hollow Hold · 3x30 sec	Side Plank · 3x20 sec/side

Progression Rules

- **Form first.** If form breaks, the set is over. Quality > reps.
- **Add weight slowly.** 2.5–5 lbs per movement per week is plenty.
- **Last rep should feel hard.** If reps 8–10 are easy, the weight is too light.
- **Track every session.** Notebook, phone, app — pick one and stick to it.

What Changes in 4 Weeks

Week 1

Movement quality. You learn the lifts.

Week 2

Confidence. You stop second-guessing form.

Week 3

Strength. Weights start climbing.

Week 4

Identity. You're a woman who lifts.

Ready for a custom plan?

Kendra builds plans around your real body, schedule, and goals. [Message her.](#)

EmpowerHer Fitness · Coaching by Kendra Washington · turnkeyweb.org/empowerher/